Project 2 | charity: water Game Concept

The marketing team at charity: water wants you to mock-up a game inspired by their global mission, with the goal of raising awareness among young people.

For your first step, choose from the provided ideas, or come up with a game concept of your own. Then, break down what the game would look like on the screen. Plan core elements like layout, interaction, and feedback. Finally, you'll submit a mock-up of the game.

Step 1: Choose Your Game Idea

Your goal is to decide on a game that would be fun, engaging, and relevant for charity: water's goals. Choose something you'd enjoy working on, and that you would be excited to share in your portfolio later on!

Here are some ideas to get you started (feel free to go with those!) —

- **Water Quest:** A fast-paced, whack-a-mole-style game where players tap charity: water's signature yellow jerry cans to earn points. Include a score counter, feedback messages, milestones, and optional obstacles to make it more engaging.
- **Water Drop:** In this game, users collect as many falling water drops as possible while avoiding pollutants (bad drops). Users tap to collect drops before they hit the ground. Include a score counter, feedback messages, and penalties for "bad drops" to make it more engaging.

Don't like these ideas? Use AI tools to help you brainstorm a game concept, or build on the provided examples. Here's a prompt suggestion:

Try this prompt

I'm designing a simple web app game to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see: charitywater.org). The goal is specifically to engage college students. My goal is to create something fun, **[add any specific game elements you'd like]**. It also needs to be simple enough for me to build using HTML, CSS and JS **[add any additional skills or languages]**, with my current skills **[describe skill level]** and in **[add desired time to spend]**. Help me come up with ideas. For each idea, explain the game mechanics and break down what I would need to build.

Remember, brainstorming with AI is a conversation. Be discerning about the results, and don't be afraid to ask follow up questions or correct the AI if what it is suggesting sounds too complicated.

Step 2: Mock-Up Your Game

Create a visual mock-up of your game using hand-drawing. Your mock-up should show the key features of your game and include branded logos.

For this deliverable, we are looking for **two pages total (No AI for this)**:

- A **Starting Page** that shows how a player begins the game.
- A **Gameplay Page** that shows what the game looks like while it is being played and how it works.

As you design each page, think about what the player sees on screen, such as the title, score, buttons, progress bars, icons, or avatars. Be sure to include all

elements, even those users often take for granted, like a 'start' button or a message that tells the player the game has ended.

- **Ready for a LevelUp? (20pts extra credit)**
    - **Use a Digital Mock Up Tool instead of the hand-drawing (10pts):** Use one of the following tools: Figma, Balsamiq, Canva, or Adobe XD (or similar) to create like a pro. It is still expected that you will create the deliverable of two pages. Many of these tools offer a free limited-time demo. We do not want you using AI tools to create this mock up.
    - **Build For Different Devices (10pts):** Think of your game being played on mobile screens and laptops. Create mock-ups for each to show how screen size will impact the layout and gameplay.

Step 3: Plan the Game Logic

Using the template provided below, write up a short explanation of how the game logic works. Ask yourself: What actions does the player take? What gets updated—score, timer, achievements? What feedback does the player get (e.g., animations, visual cues, milestone unlocks)?

Word of advice: Keep it simple — you will have opportunities to iterate and expand your game later, but done is better than perfect, and you have a deadline! Your initial goal is to get started with something that you can do.

Use AI to verify that your game logic makes sense. Here's a sample prompt:

Try this prompt

Attached is my mock-up of a web game designed to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see:

charitywater.org). My game logic includes: **[insert description]**. Does this make sense? Identify any weaknesses in my game logic or opportunities for improvement.

As your understanding of the game logic deepens, return to step 2 and adjust your mock-up, removing unnecessary elements and adding new ones.

Step 4: Add Branding

When designing a game for an organization looking to increase awareness, it's important to build the brand's assets into the design. Refine your initial sketch by adding colors, icons, and styles that align with **charity: water's brand guidelines**. If you're keeping your mock-up minimal, include notes on where the brand's colors, images, links, or icons will be incorporated.

Step 5: Submit Your Work

Happy with your mock-up? Capture a clear, high-quality image of your game idea, and complete the following in order to submit your work.

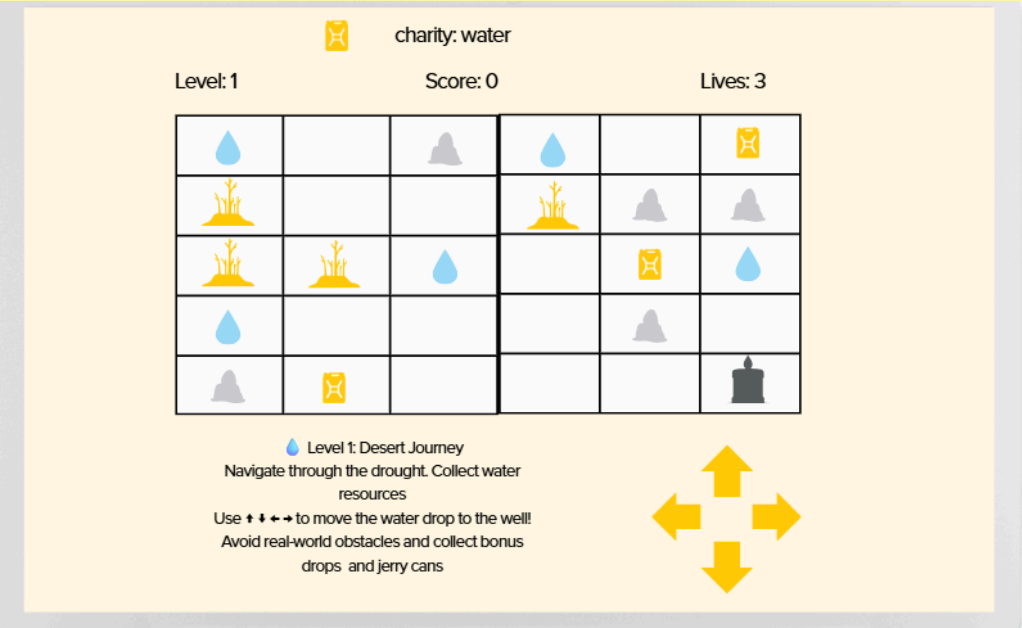
1. Let's see it! Add your game mock-up here:

<paste your image here. No links please! >

1B. Did you complete either of the two LevelUps available: Build for Different Devices and/or Use a Digital Mock-Up Tool instead of hand-drawing? To help

the evaluator easily spot your work and award the bonus points you earned, please write them below.

I did both levels ups.



2. Fill in the template provided below and paste in a full description of the game logic (how the game works, what users do, what happens when they do it, etc). This description should be written in a no-frills style, as if breaking down the logic that needs to be coded into the game for an engineering team. **(30pt)**

(Write your own game logic below, following the template format 👇)

Water Drop Journey – Game Logic

1. Game Start

- When the game loads, the start screen appears with the game title, a short message about providing clean water, and a **"Start Game"** button.
- Once the game begins, the player sees:
  - The playable character (water drop)
  - Collectible items (water drops and jerry cans) are placed throughout the level
  - Environmental obstacles (rocks, barriers)
  - A visible **timer**, **score counter**, and **lives indicator**
- Each level begins with a brief caption explaining how the level relates to real-world water access challenges.

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2. Player Actions

- The player can **move the water drop** using the arrow keys, WASD, or touch controls.
- The player can:
  - Collect water drops to increase score
  - Collect jerry cans to represent delivering water to communities
- The game responds to player actions by:
  - Increasing score when items are collected
  - Playing a sound or animation for successful collection
  - Reducing lives or triggering a penalty when an obstacle is hit

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3. Game Logic

- The game constantly checks for:
  - Item collisions (collectibles or obstacles)
  - Remaining time
  - Remaining lives
- Rules include:
  - All required water items must be collected to complete the level
  - Hitting an obstacle reduces lives or temporarily slows the player down

    - If time runs out before all items are collected, the level fails

- Difficulty increases by adding more obstacles, tighter paths, or shorter time limits in later levels.

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4. Score & Feedback

- The score increases based on:
    - Number of water drops collected
    - Jerry cans collected
    - Time remaining at level completion
- Visual and audio feedback includes:
    - Animations when items are collected
    - Sound effects for success or mistakes
    - On-screen messages such as **"Water Delivered!"** or **"Obstacle Hit!"**
- At the end of each level, players see a summary screen showing:
    - Score earned
    - People helped (symbolic representation)
    - Bonus rewards earned

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5. Win or Lose Conditions

- **Win Condition:**
  - The player collects all required water items before time runs out.
  - A success screen appears showing progress toward building or supplying a well.
- **Lose Condition:**
  - The player runs out of time or lives.
  - A message explains the challenge and encourages a reply.
- Both outcomes reinforce the game's message about water access challenges.

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6. Reset / Replay

- The player can restart the current level or return to the main menu at any time.
- On reset:
  - The level reloads
  - Score, time, and lives reset
  - Items and obstacles return to their original positions
- Players are encouraged to replay levels to improve their score, earn rewards, or unlock new content.

[Insert game title here] - Game Logic:

1. Game Start:
  - What happens when the game first loads or starts?
  - Are any elements placed on the screen? (e.g., items, score, timer)

2. Player Actions:
  - What can the player click, tap, move, or do?
  - How does the game respond to those actions?

3. Game Logic:
  - What rules or conditions should the game check for?
  - What happens when the player succeeds or fails at something?

4. Score/Feedback:
  - How is the score updated?
  - What visual or audio feedback appears based on player actions?

5. Win or Lose Conditions:
  - How does the game end?
  - What happens when the game ends (e.g., show a message, reset option)?

6. Reset/Replay:
  - Can the player restart the game? What happens on reset?

3. Write up a note for your charity: water stakeholders describing your game idea. Imagine this as the body of the email that you send along with your mock-up image. Here, your writing can focus less on the nitty-gritty details, and more on the exciting elements of the game and why you believe users will love it. Highlight how and where charity: water brand assets (colors, images,

link to website etc) will be incorporated. Your goal is to get them excited about your idea, and get stakeholder approval to continue building the game! **(10pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

Hello charity: water Team,

I'm excited to share a mock-up and early concept for a short, interactive web game designed to engage college students with charity: water's mission of providing clean and safe water for all. The experience translates the challenges of water access into a playful, accessible format that encourages learning, empathy, and action.

In the game, players guide a water drop through quick, engaging levels, collecting water drops and jerry cans while navigating obstacles that represent real-world barriers to clean water. Each level connects player progress to supplying or building a clean-water well, reinforcing how small actions can lead to meaningful impact.

The game incorporates charity: water's brand through a clean, minimal interface, a bright color palette inspired by your visual identity, and mission-driven imagery. Throughout the experience, players can easily access links to charitywater.org to learn more, share the project, or support your work.

I believe this concept offers a fun, mission-aligned way to reach college students where they already are, and I'd love to continue refining and building it with your feedback and approval.

Best regards,
Samantha Smith

4. Reflect on the experience of planning and building a game. What surprised you? How did you use AI to assist you? What did you learn from this experience? What would you do differently next time? **(10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

I really enjoyed planning and building this game. Next time I would definitely focus more on the small details because there are definitely some things that I left out that I didn't think about. AI definitely helped me identify weaknesses in my game and fix them quite a bit. I definitely learned that I have to remember the small details when it comes to building because without those details, it can be boring or lackluster.

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